

ONDC NETWORK DISCLOSURES

Buyer App Disclosure 1

Minimum standards for displaying search results to buyers

Document control	Details
Buyer App / Network Participant	Multiply / Multiply Tech India Pvt Ltd
Prepared on / version	7 September 2026 / 0.1 - detailed review draft
Effective date	[INSERT approved effective date; this draft is not yet effective]
Applicable domain and categories	Retail - [CONFIRM exact ONDC domain codes and enabled categories]
Covered buyer interfaces	[CONFIRM the ONDC website/app and conversational result interfaces covered]

DRAFT STATUS - NOT READY FOR UNCHANGED SUBMISSION

The attached guidance establishes disclosure topics, not Multiply's actual implementation. All operating rules below are proposed drafting assumptions, not verified live behaviour or ONDC-prescribed defaults. Engineering and business owners must confirm or replace them and complete every bracketed field. The final page is an internal review annex; remove it before publication.

1. Purpose, audience and scope

This proposed disclosure explains the minimum conditions for displaying ONDC search responses received from Seller Apps, including the treatment of incomplete records, unavailable offers, duplicate responses and Seller App whitelisting. It is intended for buyers, sellers and Seller Apps. The scope follows Section 4 and the listing-criteria template in the supplied guidance. [S1]

A listing standard determines whether a result is eligible to appear. Sorting determines the position of an eligible result and is covered separately in Buyer App Disclosure 2. Eligibility does not guarantee stock, delivery acceptance, a completed order or a particular rank.

2. Proposed baseline

Display all received results that meet the published criteria and the buyer's selected filters. Do not impose an undisclosed minimum rating, sales history, commercial relationship or preferred-Seller-App requirement. This is a candidate policy for approval, not a statement that these controls already exist.

3. Listing criteria: identity and essential information

The following table is the proposed listing-criteria register. Each rejection must correspond to a stated, measurable condition. Field meanings must be mapped to the ONDC protocol version actually implemented; the table is not a claim that every named field is universally mandatory under ONDC.

ID / listing criterion	How the criterion is measured	Effect of failure
LC01 Readable and identifiable response	The received response can be parsed and linked to its source Seller App. The provider and item identifiers required to distinguish the displayed offer are non-empty. Referenced provider/location records resolve within the received or valid linked catalogue.	Withhold the affected record. Reject the whole response only when it cannot be read or its source cannot be established.
LC02 Supported domain and category	The response domain and item category are members of the exact enabled domain/category list published in Section 8. Matching is by the configured code, not by a subjective view of the seller.	Do not display the item in an unsupported domain/category. Do not exclude the seller's other supported items.
LC03 Identifiable item and selling unit	The item has a non-blank display name, a valid category association, and an identified variant/pack/selling unit wherever these are required to distinguish the offer. The proposed required-field list is: item name, source identifiers, category, and the applicable unit/variant identifiers.	Withhold only the offer whose identity or offered unit cannot be established. No independent image-resolution or image-count threshold is proposed.
LC04 Usable item price	The displayed selling-price amount is a finite number greater than or equal to zero, with a declared supported currency. Proposed currency scope: INR. A genuine zero-price offer is not rejected solely for being zero.	Withhold an offer with a missing, non-numeric, negative or unsupported-currency price. Do not fabricate a price or treat an unknown price as zero.
LC05 Category-specific mandatory information	Check each applicable mandatory field against the field-and-validation schedule in Section 8. Failure means a specified required field is absent or does not meet its published validation rule.	Withhold the affected listing until corrected. The schedule must be completed before this rule is approved; a generic reference to "poor quality" is not a criterion.

Proportional application

An item-level data defect does not automatically suspend an entire provider or Seller App. Apply a wider restriction only where the underlying failure actually affects that wider scope. When corrected data is received, apply the same checks again; no additional sales-history probation is proposed.

3. Listing criteria: availability and validity (continued)

ID / listing criterion	How the criterion is measured	Effect of failure
LC06 Explicit unavailability	A received item/provider status explicitly marks the relevant offer disabled or unavailable, or a valid supplied quantity explicitly indicates zero saleable units. Missing quantity is not interpreted as zero.	Hide the affected unavailable offer from the purchasable-results list. An unknown stock value alone is not a rejection condition.
LC07 Explicit non-serviceability	The received serviceability result for the buyer's selected delivery location and relevant fulfilment option explicitly indicates that the offer cannot be fulfilled. Seller proximity alone does not establish serviceability.	Hide the affected non-serviceable offer for that location/option. Do not reject other serviceable offers from the same seller.
LC08 Withdrawal or specific restriction	A valid source update withdraws the exact offer, or an authenticated removal/restriction instruction identifies the affected item, provider or Seller App and its applicable scope.	Withhold only the identified scope for the duration of the withdrawal/restriction. No discretionary commercial blacklist is proposed.
LC09 Expired catalogue information	Where cached data is used, evaluate any applicable declared expiry/time-to-live against the stored source time using the implementation's verified timestamp rules. A record known to be expired is not treated as a current offer.	Refresh before presenting the expired record as current. The exact cache, expiry and refresh rules must be recorded in the internal confirmation schedule.

4. Unknown values and buyer-controlled filters

Under this proposal, unknown stock or serviceability is not treated as a confirmed failure. A result may remain visible with an availability/serviceability confirmation message, but it must not be represented as confirmed orderable before the necessary validation. Unknown seller coordinates are not a listing rejection criterion; their sorting treatment is in Disclosure 2.

Explicit buyer filters narrow the displayed set for that buyer. Record only filters actually supported, including their comparison basis: *[CONFIRM exact filter names and behaviour, or state that none are offered]*. A low relevance score alone does not exclude a result under this proposed baseline.

Result batches and access to remaining results

A result displayed on a later accessible page or message is not the same as a rejected result. Disclose any hard cap, response-collection cutoff or rule that permanently omits otherwise eligible records: *[CONFIRM collection window, result limit, refresh behaviour and how buyers access remaining results]*. Do not describe results as available when there is no buyer-accessible route to them.

5. Deduplication logic

The proposed approach removes repeat representations of the same source offer, not competing offers from different sellers or Seller Apps. Deduplication is separate from ranking.

Situation	Proposed objective treatment
Same source offer repeated	Use a composite identity consisting of Seller App identifier, provider identifier, item identifier, applicable location identifier, and variant/fulfilment identifiers needed to distinguish the offer. Treat records as duplicates only when this full identity matches.
An update to that same offer	Retain the newest valid source version or update timestamp. When neither is supplied, use local receipt sequence within that source offer. An older out-of-order update must not override a provably newer version. Apply a source withdrawal rather than resurrecting an older offer.
Same seller across different Seller Apps	Do not merge solely because the trading name, address or product title looks similar. Under this baseline, offers from different Seller Apps remain separate. Cross-Seller-App deduplication is not proposed.
Different locations, packs or fulfilment terms	Preserve distinct offers when their location, pack, variant or fulfilment identity differs. Grouping for display must not silently remove an alternative source or offer.

6. Whitelisting criteria for Seller Apps

Proposed declaration: there is no additional commercial or preferred-partner whitelist for displaying otherwise eligible responses.

Whitelisting requirement	Definition of successfully qualifying
Additional Multiply whitelist: none proposed	No bilateral listing agreement, paid membership, minimum Buyer Finder Fee, existing Multiply customer relationship or named preferred Seller App is required under this proposal.
Source/protocol checks	Any implemented source validation is covered by LC01 and the applicable protocol configuration, rather than an undisclosed preferred-partner list. <i>[CONFIRM whether any actual onboarding or whitelist restriction must instead be disclosed.]</i>

7. Operational-performance standards and observation window

No rejection or suspension based on delivery success, cancellation rate, complaint resolution, ratings, order volume or seller tenure is proposed in this draft. Accordingly, a performance observation window and minimum sample size are not applicable to this baseline. A new seller is not excluded solely because it has no transaction history.

Any actual performance-based restriction must replace this declaration with its exact metric, threshold, observation period/order count, minimum sample, treatment of insufficient history, and restoration rule. The percentages and sample windows in the guidance are illustrations, not thresholds adopted by this draft. [S1]

8. Category scope and category-specific requirements

The proposed general criteria apply consistently across the enabled categories. Only the category-specific mandatory-information schedule below varies by category. No extra commercial or performance threshold is proposed for any category. Do not publish a blanket "all categories" declaration without identifying the actual enabled scope.

Domain / category	Mandatory information and validation	Other variation
[INSERT each enabled ONDC domain code and category]	[LIST each additional required field, whether conditional, the exact pass/fail check, and the applicable source/specification reference]	None proposed. [CONFIRM or replace with the actual additional rule.]
[ADD a row for every materially different category]	[State "no additional fields" only after confirming the category requirements]	[State the precise category-specific difference, or "none".]

9. Publication, review and feedback

The approved disclosure is to be publicly accessible to buyers, sellers and Seller Apps through the locations below. Changes to listing criteria must be reflected in an updated version and changelog. Retain links to earlier published versions so readers can identify what changed. This follows the version-control and feedback structure in the supplied guidance. [S1]

Publication / feedback field	Details to complete
Public disclosure location	[INSERT the public disclosure URL and buyer-facing access route]
Related sorting disclosure	[INSERT the public location of Buyer App Disclosure 2]
Seller / Seller App feedback contact	[INSERT monitored business email and responsible team]
Previous versions and changelog	[INSERT archive location; state "initial publication" only if accurate]

A seller or Seller App reporting a visibility issue should identify the source Seller App, provider and item, search context, delivery location where relevant, time of observation and the rule believed to have been applied incorrectly. Review the concern against the published criterion and the underlying response; correct the record or implementation where appropriate. No fixed response-time commitment is invented in this draft.

10. Version history and policy boundary

Date of release	Version	Changes made
7 September 2026 (draft preparation)	0.1 - draft	Initial detailed proposal based on the supplied ONDC guidance. Not an approved or publicly effective release.
[INSERT approved release date]	[INSERT version]	[DESCRIBE confirmed rules and any changes from this draft]

Once approved, results may be excluded only under the published applicable criteria, buyer filters and disclosed result-handling rules. This proposal does not reserve an undefined right to suppress sellers for unspecified quality, business or commercial reasons. Sorting alone does not constitute listing eligibility.

ONDC NETWORK DISCLOSURES

Buyer App Disclosure 2

Sorting parameters and their relative importance

Document control	Details
Buyer App / Network Participant	Multiply / Multiply Tech India Pvt Ltd
Prepared on / version	7 September 2026 / 0.1 - detailed review draft
Effective date	[INSERT approved effective date; this draft is not yet effective]
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1. Purpose and relationship to listing standards

This proposed disclosure explains how eligible item and merchant results received from Seller Apps are ordered for buyers. It separates default ranking, merchant listing, buyer-selected sorting, tie-breakers and other possible influences. Its structure follows Section 3 and the sorting template in the supplied guidance. [S1]

Buyer App Disclosure 1 determines which received results remain eligible, including deduplication. This document concerns their order. A result's presence or position is not a guarantee that an order can be fulfilled, nor an endorsement of a seller.

2. Proposed ranking model

For item searches, use search relevance first, seller distance second, and a stable source-offer identifier only to resolve remaining ties. These are sequential priorities, not percentage weights: a lower-priority parameter cannot override a difference in a higher-priority parameter.

This relevance-first/distance-second model expands the earlier illustrative sample; it has not been verified against Multiply's deployed search system. The definitions below are concrete candidate rules for engineering review. A weighted, fuzzy-match, semantic or machine-learned implementation must be described as actually implemented instead.

3. Default item / product sorting

Apply the following parameters in descending priority to the same eligible result set. Stop comparing as soon as a higher-priority parameter distinguishes two offers.

Rank / relative importance	Sorting parameter	How the parameter is measured
1 - highest	Search relevance	Compare the exact-name-match indicator first, then query-token coverage, as defined below. Higher values rank first. Coverage does not override an exact-name match.
2 - secondary	Seller fulfilment distance	Among equal-relevance offers, place valid known distances before unknown distances; then order by ascending distance in kilometres between the buyer and the offer's linked fulfilment location. See Section 5.
3 - final tie-breaker only	Stable source-offer identity	When relevance and distance treatment are equal, compare the composite Seller App/provider/location/item/variant/fulfilment identifier tuple in ascending string order. This creates a repeatable order, not a quality score.

3.1 Objective relevance definition

Proposed text preparation: apply Unicode NFKC normalization and case folding; replace punctuation with spaces; collapse repeated whitespace; and keep letter/number tokens. Preserve numbers such as pack sizes. No stemming, synonym expansion, transliteration, semantic score or purchase-history adjustment is included in this reference calculation.

Exact-name-match indicator (E): 1 when the normalized, non-empty buyer query equals the normalized item display name; otherwise 0. Compare E in descending order.

Query-token coverage (C): let Q be the set of distinct tokens in the query, and T the set of tokens in the item name, supplied brand and declared category label. C equals the number of tokens shared by Q and T divided by the number of tokens in Q. Compare C in descending order. Missing optional brand/category labels contribute no tokens; they are not fabricated.

For an empty query, set E and C to zero for all eligible results. Distance then becomes the first effective differentiator. Compare the underlying values, not a rounded display score. A zero coverage score does not itself reject a received result under the proposed listing policy.

3.2 Worked illustration - not an implementation claim

For the query "atta 5kg", an item named "Atta 5kg" has E = 1 and C = 1. An item named "Whole Wheat Atta 5kg" has E = 0 and C = 1. The first item ranks above the second even when its seller is farther away. When both relevance values tie, distance decides the order.

4. Merchant / seller listing

This section applies only where the approved interface presents merchant results. Proposed merchant identity is the source Seller App/provider/location combination; offers received through different Seller Apps are not silently merged. *[CONFIRM whether merchant listing is supported; otherwise mark this section not applicable.]*

Rank	Merchant parameter	Objective comparison
1 - highest	Relevance for the active search	For a merchant-name search, calculate E and C using the merchant display name as the searchable text. For merchants grouped under an item search, use the best (E, C) pair among that merchant-location's eligible matching offers; the number of offers does not itself increase rank.
2	Distance	Among equal-relevance merchant results, use the buyer-to-listed-merchant-location distance. Valid known distances precede unknown values; shorter distances rank first.
3 - tie only	Stable merchant identity	Compare Seller App/provider/location identifiers in ascending string order after the earlier comparisons tie. There is no proposed preferred-Seller-App priority.

5. Distance, missing data and final ties

Proposed distance measurement: straight-line great-circle distance calculated from latitude/longitude using the haversine method with a fixed radius of 6,371 kilometres. This is a ranking measurement, not a promised road distance, route, delivery time or delivery charge. Use the unrounded calculated value for comparison.

A coordinate pair is usable only when latitude and longitude are numeric and fall within -90 to 90 and -180 to 180 respectively. Use the location linked to the particular offer or merchant card. Do not replace it with an unrelated registered-office address. Where a single offer contains multiple serviceable linked fulfilment locations, the proposed rule uses the shortest valid distance among them; engineering must confirm this aggregation.

When seller coordinates are unavailable or invalid, treat distance as unknown, never as zero. Unknown distance does not by itself exclude a result. If the buyer has not provided usable coordinates, disable distance comparison for all results in that view; the remaining disclosed comparisons determine their order.

A stable tie-breaker is applied only after all higher priorities tie. For an item, the identity includes the source, provider, item and the location/variant/fulfilment parts needed to distinguish its offer. Duplicate representations of an identical source offer are handled under Disclosure 1, rather than given additional positions.

Category browsing without a query

In an unqueried category or merchant browse view, relevance is neutral for all eligible results. Apply known distance first and the stable identifier last. If distance is also unavailable, the stable identifier determines the reference order. No random, popularity or manually curated browse ordering is proposed.

6. Buyer-selected alternative sorting

PROPOSED OPTIONS - VERIFY THE ACTUAL BUYER CONTROLS

The options below are candidate disclosure wording, not confirmation that the controls exist. Confirm each live label, its interface and its comparator. Replace unsupported options with the choices actually provided; the internal annex flags the policy requirement for alternative sorting.

Option / applicable results	Primary ordering rule	Treatment of ties
Default / Relevance Items and applicable merchant search	Use the relevance, distance and stable-identity sequence described in Sections 3-5.	Already specified in the default sequence.
Price: Low to High Item offers only	Compare the displayed item selling-price amount in the supported currency, smallest first. Do not use a merchant's cheapest unrelated item to rank the whole merchant.	Then relevance, then distance, then stable offer identity.
Price: High to Low Item offers only	Compare the same item selling-price amount, largest first. The price basis is unchanged from the ascending option.	Then relevance, then distance, then stable offer identity.
Distance: Nearest First Items and merchant locations	Put known valid distances before unknown values; then compare distance in ascending order. Distance becomes primary even when relevance differs.	Then relevance, then stable offer or merchant identity.

6.1 Price-comparison basis

The reference price sort compares the selling price of the specific displayed offer and declared unit/pack, not MRP, percentage discount, seller revenue or a predicted final basket total. Delivery charges, order-level fees and conditional cart offers are not included in this reference comparison. The display must make the tax and charge basis clear: *[CONFIRM the actual displayed price basis and included/excluded components]*.

Prices for different pack sizes are not automatically normalized to a per-kilogram, per-litre or per-piece value in this proposal. Buyers must compare the declared packs/units. An unknown price is never treated as zero; invalid-price eligibility is covered in Disclosure 1. Confirm any actual unit-price calculation before describing it.

6.2 Control behaviour and visible result limits

Buyer access route and persistence: *[CONFIRM where each sorting control appears, whether it is available in conversational results, and when a chosen option resets]*. A buyer-selected option changes ordering; it does not bypass minimum listing standards.

Where results are shown in batches or messages, disclose whether the selected sort applies to the entire collected eligible set or only to the displayed batch: *[CONFIRM scope, result-collection window, cap, late-response handling, refresh and access to remaining results]*. These settings must match Disclosure 1. Do not imply that a small visible selection contains every result received.

7. Category variation and other ranking influences

Proposed category declaration: the same default sequence and objective measurement rules apply across all enabled categories. There is no proposed food/grocery/fashion-specific change in priority. This declaration must be replaced wherever the implementation uses a different comparator, parameter or merchant/item presentation.

Domain / category	Default priority and variation
<i>[INSERT exact enabled domain codes and categories]</i>	Proposed item order: relevance, distance, stable identifier. Proposed merchant order: the relevant search-mode rule in Section 4, distance, stable identifier. No category-specific variation proposed.
<i>[ADD each actual exception, or confirm none]</i>	<i>[DEFINE the different parameters and their descending priority; identify item versus merchant results and the affected buyer interface]</i>

7.1 Commercial, personalised and automated influences

Proposed baseline: no paid or sponsored placement, commission/Buyer Finder Fee boost, ownership/affiliation boost, manual commercial preference, purchase-history personalisation, rating/popularity score, seller-tenure preference or image-quality score changes the ordering defined here. Response arrival time is not an organic ranking signal; its limited role in handling an unversioned repeat offer is described in Disclosure 1.

This is an explicit assumption requiring confirmation, not a verified absence of these features. Any actual sponsored result must be described with its buyer-visible label, placement and effect on ordering. Any actual personalisation, semantic relevance model, language transformation or automated reranking must be incorporated into the relevant parameters and their relative importance, not hidden behind the general term "AI".

For a conversational interface, preserve the approved ordering when presenting results. Any model-generated shortlist, selected-seller recommendation or change in order must be disclosed as an additional selection/ranking step, with its real inputs and relative influence. The current treatment is *[CONFIRM the actual conversational selection and rendering behaviour]*.

8. Feedback, publication and version history

Sellers can assess discoverability by checking their supplied item/merchant names, relevant catalogue attributes and fulfilment coordinates against the approved parameter definitions. Meeting listing criteria does not guarantee the highest rank. A ranking concern should include the search, delivery context, time, source Seller App, provider/item and selected sort option.

Publish the current approved version with links to earlier releases and a changelog. Update this disclosure when parameters, their priority, category treatment or buyer controls change, and record the effective date so the published explanation remains aligned with operations. [S1]

Feedback contact: *[INSERT monitored email and responsible team]*.

Public disclosure / buyer access: *[INSERT location and access route]*.

Related minimum-standards disclosure: *[INSERT location of Disclosure 1]*.

Previous versions and changelog: *[INSERT archive location]*.

Date of release	Version	Changes made
7 September 2026 (draft preparation)	0.1 - draft	Expanded reference model: separate item/merchant ranking, measured relevance and distance, alternative sorts, ties, category variation and review gates. Not yet effective.
<i>[INSERT approved date]</i>	<i>[INSERT version]</i>	<i>[DESCRIBE confirmed implementation and changes]</i>